

VIHARA ALSO GIVES DANCERS **THE OPPORTUNITY TO SPEND TIME IN THE SYLVAN DANCE GURUKUL,** REHEARSE IN BEAUTIFULLY DECORATED SPACES DESIGNED BY GERARD DA CUNHA AND ENJOY THE LOCALLY GROWN FOOD

time and trust that's afforded to them.

But that's not the only attractive bit of Vihara. It's the opportunity to spend time in the sylvan Nrityagram dance gurukul located in Hessarghatta and rehearse in the beautifully decorated spaces designed by architect Gerard da Cunha and enjoy the locally grown food that makes it more enticing. "When dancers live within an environment where dance is woven into daily life, artistic growth unfolds organically and continuously," says Fernandez. "Here, dance is not approached simply as a profession or performance practice. It becomes part of how you live, reflect, observe, learn and relate to the world." Sen's vibrant choreographies for Nrityagram Dance Ensemble are reflective of the inspiring effects of the environment. What Vihara does is open its doors to classical dancers from other styles to benefit from the holistic environment.

Sen and Fernandez also see it as a respite for dancers from the rigour of their own journeys, which sees them perform, teach, choreograph, collaborate and these days even engage with audiences through social media. "We felt there was immense value in creating a space where dancers could spend uninterrupted time with their art form," says Fernandez. The residency, they hope, would forge a connection among the dancers. "Spaces like these create opportunities for artistes across traditions and generations to learn from one another, exchange experiences and build lasting relationships through dance," says Sen. ■

—Suhani Singh

For details, visit nrityagram.org/dance-residency





◀ **JUNE 6** | ***Prism Club and Kitchen,*** *Hyderabad*

Bombay Rockers Live

Bombay Rockers return to Hyderabad with a performance driven by nostalgia, dance floor energy and viral contemporary appeal. Riding renewed popularity through 'Aari Aari' from *Dhurandhar*, the act is expected to blend classic favourites with crowd-driven anthems. The concert promises booming electronic beats, singalong hooks and a high-energy late-night atmosphere shaped by collective celebration and pop nostalgia.

▶ **JUNE 11** | ***Nehru Centre,*** *Mumbai*

SAMANVAY

'Samanvay – Two Traditions. One Experience' brings together Carnatic vocalist Sudha Raghunathan and Hindustani exponent Ashwini Bhide-Deshpande for a jugalbandi performance, in a dialogue betwen two classical traditions.



Ashwini Bhide-Deshpande



◀ **MAY 15** | ***Windmills Craftworks,*** *Hyderabad;* **MAY 16-17** | ***Windmills Craftworks,*** *Bengaluru*

Stanley Jordan Live

Guitarist Stanley Jordan brings his pioneering two-handed "touch technique" to India. Known for blending melody and harmony simultaneously, Jordan rose to global acclaim with *Magic Touch* and moves fluidly between jazz, fusion and improvisation.

—compiled by ***Nikhil Sardana***